My shortlist includes **Bill McBride** (Calculated Risk) who reduces economics and housing to its simplest essence; **Sam Ro** understands what drives markets better than most on Wall Street. **Torsten Slok**'s charts are thought-provoking and insightful. Nobody integrates data with investing narrative better than my colleague **Ben Carlson**. I devour all of **Morgan Housel**'s columns for their insight and smarts; **Claudia Sahm** for all things Fed related; few people can help you understand bad investing behavior better than **Jason Zweig** of the *Wall Street Journal*. **Dave Nadig** is my ETF ZenMaster, **Jonathan Miller**, my housing wizard. **Ed Hyman** is the best economist ever. I'll stop at 10, but there are many others.

Create your own list of those whose methods, analytics and track records add value. Remember, this is a process of elimination; and accountability (our *prior* bullet point) keeps your list small.

Focus your financial television consumption

Truth be told, most financial television is boring. People pontificating about *whatever* is not entertaining.

Why is that? FinTV is essentially *televised radio*. It lacks compelling visuals, and so there is massive over-compensation. The lack of visuals also drives manufactured conflict—the pseudo bull/bear debates that a producer told me makes for "compelling TV." (Bleccch.)

YouTube lets me cherry-pick the best of financial television: **Tom Keene** of Bloomberg Surveillance; on CNBC, my colleague **Josh Brown** is so insightful and witty that he makes anything fun to watch. UBS Floor Manager **Art Cashin**'s comments from the NYSE floor is must-see TV. You will hear more wisdom in 30 seconds from Cashin than any other 10 pundits combined. On Bloomberg TV, **David Rubenstein** hosts amazing conversations. **Consuelo Mack**'s web show, WealthTrack, slows it down with in-depth interviews with investing legends. She is a modern-day **Louis Rukeyser**.